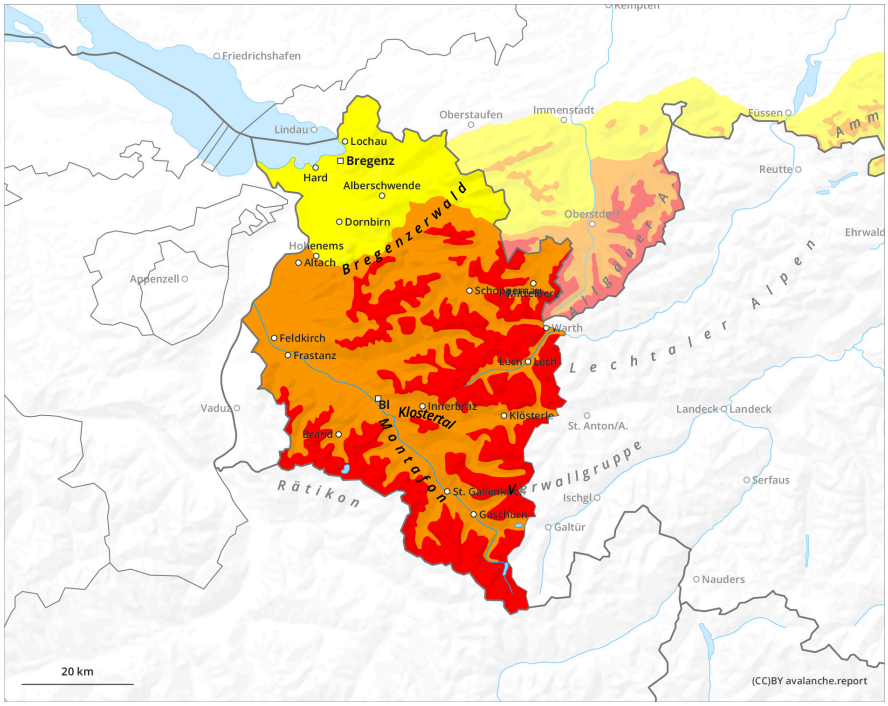
Tuesday 17 February 2026

Updated 17 Feb 2026, 07:32:00
Valid from 16 Feb 2026, 17:00:00 until 17 Feb 2026, 17:00:00
Written by Andreas Pecl

Lots of fresh snow and stormy winds: critical avalanche situation



1	2	3	4	5
low	moderate	considerable	high	very high

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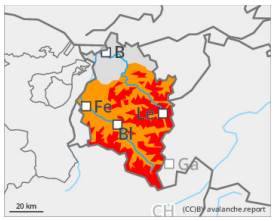
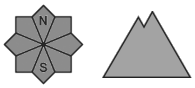
Danger Level 4 - High

1800m

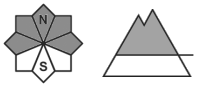
Tendency: Constant avalanche danger
on Wednesday 18 February 2026



New snow



Persistent
weak layer



2000m

High avalanche danger widespread

Intensive precipitation and storm-strength winds are leading to high avalanche danger. Avalanches can easily be triggered by one single winter sports enthusiast or be triggered naturally. Exposed areas can be placed at risk. Danger zones occur on steep slopes near to and distant from ridgelines, behind drops in the landscape and in wind-loaded gullies and bowls. Frequency and spread of avalanche prone locations increase with ascending altitude. Whumpf noises and fractures which appear when treading upon the snowpack, as well as freshly released avalanches are alarm signals. Activities in outlying terrain demand restraint. The inexperienced should not leave secured ski runs.

Snowpack

By Tuesday evening, 30-50cm of fresh snow was registered. During the daytime the snowfall continued. Storm-strength westerly-to-northwesterly winds transported the snow, generate fresh snowdrift accumulations. Fresh snow and drifts often lie deposited on top of graupel, in wind-protected terrain also atop surface hoar or on thin, trigger-sensitive melt-freeze layers. Also older snowdrifts and the weak snowpack will be blanketed by fresh snowfall.

Weather

From dense cloud cover, heavy snowfall, poor visibility, brisk winds, wintery cold temperatures. Temperature at 2000m: -8 degrees; at 3000m: -15 degrees. Strong to storm-strength westerly-to-northwesterly winds at high altitudes.

Tendency

As precipitation tapers off, danger of naturally triggered avalanches will gradually diminish. Situation remains treacherous for winter sports enthusiasts.